Hilal International Academy

Mogadishu-Somalia

Student and Parents Information Handbook

2024

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Background

Welcome to Hilal International Academy. This handbook is a single guide to new and existing students on procedures followed in the day-to-day running of our schools. It is a tool to be used in obtaining information needed by the students, especially during the induction period. The information provided in this handbook will guide the students to fit well into the school system and to acquaint themselves with the background, policies, expectations, targets, ethos, philosophy, principles and standard practices of Hilal International Academy schools.

However, students' induction is not only provided by mere reading of this handbook. The school administration makes every supportive effort possible to induct students behaviorally and practically. This handbook always acts as a reminder that is referred to by students in our school on several issues related to school life. Understanding and internalizing the content therein should be a good step forward in the students' planning, goal setting, overcoming challenges and team building. Policies and procedures in our school are standardised but are not static. A periodic review is done to cater for the needs of all stakeholders. Should you wish clarification on any of the issues contained in the handbook do not hesitate to contact the school administration. We hope that you will have a great experience studying in our schools.

School Motto
"Centre for Academic Excellence"
Our Vision

To be a safe learning environment in which pupils are empowered to seek, acquire and demonstrate knowledge, skills and values that will serve them and their communities in the future.

Our Mission

To provide a progressive education that enables learners to attain their full potential as responsible, productive, creative and compassionate global citizens.

The ethos of the school

i. Providing a framework for students to become holistic individuals and responsible citizens.
ii. Maintaining open, positive and collaborative links with parents.
iii. Nurturing high personal standards, good ethics, responsibility and respect for students at all times.
iv. Enhancing and supporting individuals through respect, training, communication and individualized support.
v. Maintaining a high standard of discipline, respect, accountability, grooming and poise of the students.
vi. Promoting readiness to contribute to the community and providing leadership for it.
vii. Ensuring that parents are regularly advised of the progress of the students including difficulties of their personal or disciplinary nature.
viii. Promoting all school activities to encourage all students to fulfil their social, cultural and sporting potential.
ix. To instil in our students the determination and self-management to meet the challenges of an ever-changing technological world.
x. Involving our students in the promotion of a caring and compassionate society, both within the school and in the outside world.
xi. Enabling students to display agility of thought and action when faced with changing circumstances.
xii. Promoting international mindedness by developing an understanding of the interdependence of individuals and groups with diverse needs.

Core Values

The schools embrace the values to achieve its mission, Vision and goals.

- Learner-centeredness
- Openness to experimentation and change
- A commitment to sharing and hearing all opinions respectfully.
- Embracing cultural diversity
- Global environmental consciousness.
- Identification and development of talent.
- Students' Holistic Development & Support.
- Community engagement
- Collaboration
- Integrity

Aims and Objectives of the School

i. To provide an accessible and affordable balanced education to all, irrespective of ethnicity, culture, creed or political affiliation.
ii. To provide a welcoming and supportive learning environment which facilitates every child's learning.
iii. To provide leadership in sharing responsibility for education between the school faculty, the students, the parents and the wider community.
iv. To provide interactive educational experiences which develop the skills for independent research and a problem-solving approach for students in and out of the classroom.
v. To develop an understanding and appreciation of the beliefs and values of different cultures, so that students may develop a sense of good global citizenship.
vi. To provide choices and guidance within the educational programmes throughout the entire learning process.
vii. To prepare students for the challenges of a global society.
viii. To provide a safe and secure supportive, caring, learner-centred environment in which everyone feels valued.
ix. To develop inquisitive, knowledgeable and caring young adults who have clear intercultural and international understanding and respect.
x. To build motivation and self-esteem by helping young persons of diverse abilities, to experience positive reinforcement and success in their school life.
xi. To maximize the academic, creative physical and intellectual potential of every student while raising awareness of global and environmental issues.
xii. To value and encourage behaviour that is principled, responsible and considers equal opportunity to be a fundamental right regardless of race, culture or belief.
xiii. To provide opportunities for career growth and professional development to all students.
xiv. To provide a wide diversity of co-curricular and sporting activities to challenge and widen the experience of learners and to enhance mutual respect and self-esteem amongst stakeholders.
xv. To encourage the development of a sense of inquiry, and to nurture open-minded, balanced, risk-taking and reflective thinking that can be communicated effectively by learners.
xvi. To provide students with expert career advice and support to enable them to gain access to suitable further education in learning institutions throughout the world.

Philosophy of the school

Hilal International Academy is committed to fostering an inclusive, diverse, and academically rigorous environment. The Academy embraces the International Baccalaureate (IB), it admits students from diverse backgrounds, promoting an open learning atmosphere, ensuring equitable access to its programmes. The academy's academic integrity upholds ethical standards, fostering a culture of honesty and responsibility. The school celebrates multilingualism and develops language skills as valuable assets. The assessment aligns with IB principles, providing equitable opportunities for all students.

What kind of student will HIA produce?

A student of Hilal International Academy School will develop high levels of self-respect, self-esteem, respect and care so as to become an independent, innovative and reflective thinker who will take into consideration environmental protection. The child will be nurtured to be open-minded, knowledgeable, inquirer, and morally upright in order to prepare for the challenging future. Our student will develop a love of learning, set high personal standards for their learning and develop an understanding of excellence and how it can be achieved both educationally and creatively.

Teacher Role and Profile

Our teachers mould, coach and mentor students in all aspects of life. They work with children on all school activities while ensuring that children develop independent work ethics, leadership and interpersonal skills.

The school faculty carefully plans school activities and takes full responsibility for those activities in and out of class, aiming to achieve high standards in all facets. Teachers undergo in-service professional development training to provide exposure and understanding of the expected curriculum standards and contemporary practices. They are imaginative, caring, very creative and highly motivated professionals who cherish adding value to children's quest for knowledge.

Our teachers will relentlessly work towards helping students achieve the best qualities, skills and values by;

- Continually seeking to improve standards of teaching, and learning.
- Making learning stimulating, challenging, exciting and enjoyable.
- Using teaching and learning strategies matched to individual learning styles
- Teaching students how to learn effectively
- Creating opportunities for students to apply their learning to entirely new situations
- Presenting achievable but challenging opportunities for success
- Rewarding positive attitudes, behaviour and success
- Constructively correcting negative attitudes and behaviour
- Encouraging students to learn from their inevitable mistakes
- Giving students increasingly responsible roles within the school
- Encouraging students to help and care for others
- Teaching students the fundamental importance of positive human relationships
- Providing opportunities to make a positive contribution to their environment and school
- Working with parents in close partnership, offering regular consultations, encouraging involvement and supporting their children's learning and ensuring accessibility and participation in the life of the school.

School Curriculum

Hilal International Academy which is a candidate school seeking to be authorized **offers** the International Baccalaureate, Primary Year Programme (PYP) and Middle Year Programme Curriculum.

School Rules and Regulations for Students

Preamble:

These School rules and regulations are necessary to place limitations on unacceptable behaviour in school. They serve not only to control undesirable behaviour but also to teach proper behaviour. These rules and regulations guide the students to enable them to attain the ultimate goals and virtues to which the school aspires. Students, parents and teachers are partners in ensuring that these rules are upheld. These rules are an agreement between students and parents. On admission, each Student and parent are given time to read and internalize these rules, obligations and expectations, after which the parent and Student sign a copy of the school rules which is kept in the student's file. Failure to follow these rules will result in consequences for students.

1. Authority:

All Students are expected to respect the school principal, vice principal, Head section and other administrators, teachers, support staff, Students' leaders and fellow Students.

2. Rights and Responsibilities of Students

Students have a right to benefit from the educational opportunities offered to them in our schools. This entails not only the right to access those opportunities but also the right to be protected from disruptive influences within the school. To benefit from the educational opportunities provided for them, students must assume important responsibilities for learning, which include among others;

a) Being in school when physically able, punctuality for school and classes, dressing appropriately, participating in class discourse and other activities, seeking clarification by asking questions, doing class work and other assignments, making up all work missed due to absence, and achieving one's personal best at all times and taking responsibility for their own learning.

b) Students have a right to complain when other Students disrupt a classroom and prevent them from learning.

c) Through the Students Council/Prefects Body, students have a right to present recommendations to teachers and administrators to suggest changes to any policy, procedure, rule, or regulation.

d) Students have the right to be taught the appropriate material at the specified time in a professionally accepted way.

e) Students have the right to safety and security as well as human treatment.

f) All students have the right to attend school and their individual differences are respected and they are free of fear of harassment and bullying.

g) All Students have the responsibility to learn to be sensitive to the needs and rights of others and to be aware of the consequences of the actions of themselves and others.

General Expectations.

Students are expected at all times to behave in a restrained, responsible way and to conduct themselves in accordance with the school rules, and regulations, and in a manner that contributes to an orderly operation of the school. Students are expected to be morally upright, and punctual to school, classroom and to all school activities.

Arrival

The school day starts at 7.30 am. Any Student not in the school by **7:30 am** will be considered as being late, have their names recorded and parents notified. Students' punctuality to school and to all school activities is very paramount.

Tardiness

A Student is considered late when he or she arrives at an assigned place after the time his or her schedule requires him or her to be there. Repeated tardiness is an unwelcome personal habit and also disrupts the learning process. The school will not tolerate tardiness and unauthorized Student

absenteeism. Excessive unexcused tardiness may result in a truancy referral. All cases of tardiness shall be reported to the parents/ legal guardians who may be called in case of a child's persistent tardiness.

Absence from School

All Students are expected to attend school every school day. A Student who misses school must bring a note signed by parents on the day they attend school. The Principal/Head section may permit a Student to be absent because of personal illness, death in the family, religious holidays or emergencies that, in the judgment of the principal/Head section require a student to be absent provided that notification and appropriate documentation has been given the parent/legal guardian. The principal/Head section may discipline a student for unexcused absences and excessive tardiness.

Conduct.

i. Students are expected to report to school on the first day of each semester. In case of failure to report for any reason, a parent/ legal guardian shall inform the school.
ii. All Students are required to uphold the good name of the Academy. This covers conduct outside school.
iii. A Student who wishes to leave the school premises for any reason must seek permission from the school administrator.
iv. Students will be respectful team players and desist from aggressive or provocative behaviour.
v. Students will be guided on areas considered out of bounds and shall be expected to avoid accessing such areas unless authorized.
vi. Discrimination and intolerance of any kind i.e. in regard to colour, race, religion, ethnicity, social status or family background is a serious offence.
vii. The School supports the maintenance of a working and learning environment for Students that provides for fair and equitable treatment, including freedom from sexual discrimination and harassment. No student, male or female, shall discriminate on the basis of sex; harass another Student by making unwelcome sexual advances or requests for sexual favours; or engage in other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature.
viii. Any Student who believes he or she has been subjected to sexual harassment or discrimination should report immediately to any staff in authority (or to his or her teacher, who shall immediately report the incident to the Principal/Head section).
ix. Bullying: Bullying is prohibited in our school. This refers to any intentional electronic, written, verbal or physical act of aggression directed at another Student(s) in the school, on school grounds, in school vehicles, or at any activity sponsored, supervised or sanctioned by the school. Bullying shall also include;
   - Any act by a Student which may create a fear that interferes with another Student's ability to do any school work
   - Any act by a Student which may substantially interfere with another student's education;
   - Any act by a student which may create a threatening environment for another student.
x. Any Incidents of harassment or bullying should be immediately reported to the Principal/Head section or any teacher.
xi. Use of vulgar, demeaning, degrading, humiliating insulting or foul language is prohibited in school, whether gestural, spoken or written.
xii. No business transactions shall be allowed in school except activities officially organized or permitted by the school authority for academic or philanthropic/charitable reasons.

Health and Safety.

It is the responsibility of all members of the school community, including Students to keep and maintain a neat, clean, hygienic and pleasant school environment.

i. Students will be guided on areas where all food and drinks can be consumed. Classrooms, Libraries, and Laboratories will not be used for eating and drinking.
ii. Disposal of rubbish should be into the litter bins provided.

iii. The school canteen is accessible to Students only at break time, lunchtime and after school.
iv. It is the responsibility of every student to look after their own personal belongings and to respect other personal property. Stealing is a serious offence. Use of someone else's property without permission from the owner is strictly prohibited.
v. Students should avoid public displays of affection or intimate relationships in the school and during school-related activities.

Co-curricular Activities

All Students will be expected to participate in sports, clubs, house activities and other school events.

Uniform:

i. Full school uniforms must be neat and clean, and conform to standards of safety, good taste, and decency worn by students while in school and on official school trips.
ii. Sports uniforms are **ONLY** worn for Physical and Health Education (PHE).
iii. Clothing that exposes cleavage, or undergarments, or that is provocative, is prohibited. Examples of prohibited garments include sagging or low-cut trousers and skirts, low-cut necklines that show cleavage, tube tops, halter tops, backless blouses or blouses with only ties in the back, studded belts, chain belts, see-through material fabrics, and head coverings unless required for religious or medical purposes.
iv. Dress code for informal activities will be defined for every occasion and must be strictly observed.
v. The school uniform comprises

Boys

- Dark red trousers and White shirts (KGs)
- White long/short sleeved shirts
- Maroon trousers for the Primary Year Programme (PYP)
- Dark-blue trousers for the Middle Year Programme (MYP)
- Sports wear
- Track suit
- Class T-Shirt (Long or short sleeved)- varies for different levels
- White gowns for science laboratory

Girls

- Dark-red Hijab and long dress (KGs)
- Hijab and long dress (Brown) for PYP
- Hijab and long dress (Dark-Blue) for MYP
- White gowns for science laboratory

Academics

i. Attendance of all lessons, class activities, assignments and examinations and any sessions organized by the school is mandatory for all Students. All Students are expected to attend a minimum of 80% of the course lessons allotted for each semester.
ii. Engagement in all set academic tasks e.g. assignments, study trips, projects, fairs, exhibitions, seminars or fieldwork arranged by the school is compulsory. Social trips abroad and within Somalia are optional.
iii. No student shall engage in any form of academic dishonesty and malpractice during a lesson, in an assignment, project, test, examination or presentation.

Curriculum

The IB mission and the Primary Years Programme (PYP)

The International Baccalaureate aims to develop inquiring, knowledgeable and caring young people who help to create a better and more peaceful world through intercultural understanding and respect. To this end, the organisation works with schools, governments and international organisations to

develop challenging programmes of international education and rigorous assessment.
These programmes encourage students across the world to become active, compassionate and lifelong
Learners who understand that people, with their differences, can also be right.
Hilal International Academy is committed to delivering the International Baccalaureate (IB) Programmes. In the Primary School, the Primary Years Programme (PYP) is followed from Nursery to Grade 5 as seen in the table below;

Table: 1 Primary Years Programme Structure

Student Age (Years)	Grade
4-5	Nursery 1
5-6	Nursery 2
6-7	Grade 1
7-8	Grade 2
8-9	Grade 3
9-10	Grade 4
10-12	Grade 5

Table: 1:1: At HIA, as IB learners we strive to be:

Inquirers	We nurture our curiosity, developing skills for inquiry and research. We know how to learn independently and with others. We learn with enthusiasm and sustain our love of learning throughout life.
Knowledgeable	We develop and use conceptual understanding, exploring knowledge across a range of disciplines. We engage with issues and ideas that have local and global significance.
Thinkers	We use critical and creative thinking skills to analyse and take responsible action on complex problems. We exercise initiative in making reasoned, ethical decisions.
Communicators	We express ourselves confidently and creatively in more than one language and in many ways. We collaborate effectively, listening carefully to the perspectives of other individuals and groups.
Principled	We act with integrity and honesty, with a strong sense of fairness and justice, and with respect for the dignity and rights of people everywhere. We take responsibility for our actions and their consequences.
Open-minded	We critically appreciate our own cultures and personal histories, as well as the values and traditions of others. We seek and evaluate a range of points of view, and we are willing to grow from the experience.
Caring	We show empathy, compassion and respect. We have a commitment to service, and we act to make a positive difference in the lives of others and in the world around us.
Risk-takers	We approach uncertainty with forethought and determination; we work independently and cooperatively to explore new ideas and innovative strategies. We are resourceful and resilient in the face of challenges and change.
Balanced	We understand the importance of balancing different aspects of our lives- intellectual, physical, and emotional-to achieve well-being for

	ourselves and others. We recognize our interdependence with other people and with the world in which we live.
Reflective	We thoughtfully consider the world and our own ideas and experiences. We work to understand our strengths and weaknesses to support our learning and personal development.

Note: The IB learner profile represents 10 attributes valued by IB world schools. We believe these attributes, and others like them, can help individuals and groups become responsible members of local, national and global communities.

Table: 2 Transdisciplinary Themes

Transdisciplinary themes	Descriptions
Who we are	An inquiry into the nature of the self; beliefs and values; personal, physical, mental, social and spiritual health; human relationships including families, friends, communities and cultures; rights and responsibilities; what it means to be human.
Where we are in place and time	An inquiry into orientation in place and time; personal histories; homes and journeys; the discoveries, explorations and migrations of humankind; the relationship between, and the interconnectedness of, individuals and civilizations from local and global perspectives.
How we express ourselves	An inquiry into the ways in which we discover and express ideas, feelings, nature, culture, beliefs and values; the ways in which we reflect on, extend and enjoy our creativity; our appreciation of the aesthetic.
How the world works	An inquiry into the natural world and its laws; the interaction between the natural world (physical and biological) and human societies; how humans use their understanding of scientific principles; the impact of scientific and technological advances on society and on the environment.
How we organize ourselves	An inquiry into the interconnectedness of human-made systems and communities; the structure and function of organizations; societal decision-making; economic activities and their impact on humankind and the environment.
Sharing the planet	An inquiry into rights and responsibilities in the struggle to share finite resources with other people and with other living things; communities and the relationships within and between them; access to equal opportunities; peace and conflict resolution.

Approaches to learning (ATLs)

Approaches to learning (ATLs) are an integral part of an IB education and complement the learner profile, knowledge, conceptual understanding and inquiry.

These skills are grounded in the belief that learning how to learn is fundamental to a student's education. Five categories of interrelated skills aim to support students of all ages to become self-regulated learners who know how to ask good questions, set effective goals and pursue their aspirations with the determination to achieve them. These skills also help to support students' sense of agency, encouraging them to see their learning as an active and dynamic process (IBO 2017).

Although the ATLs are relevant from 3 to 19 years of age, it is particularly important for PYP teachers to interpret these skills in ways that are appropriate for early and primary

years learners. All teachers foster and support the development of these skills by providing opportunities embedded in authentic learning experiences.

Table: 2:1 Approaches to learning skills for PYP students

Category	**Sub-skills**
Thinking skills	● Critical-thinking skills (analyzing and evaluating issues and ideas) ● Creative-thinking skills (generating novel ideas and considering new perspectives). ● Transfer skills (using skills and knowledge in multiple contexts) ● Reflection/metacognitive skills ((re)considering the process of learning)
Research skills	● Information-literacy skills (formulating and planning, data gathering and recording, synthesizing and interpreting, evaluating and communicating). ● Media-literacy skills (interacting with media to use and create ideas and information) ● Ethical use of media/information (understanding and applying social and ethical technology)
Communication skills	● Exchanging-information skills (listening, interpreting, speaking) ● Literacy skills (reading, writing and using language to gather and communicate information). ● ICT skills (using technology to gather, investigate and communicate information)
Social skills	● Developing positive interpersonal relationships and collaboration skills (using self-control, managing setbacks, and supporting peers). ● Developing social-emotional intelligence
Self-management skills	● Organization skills (managing time and tasks effectively) ● States of mind (mindfulness, perseverance, emotional management, self-motivation, resilience)

Our Middle Years Programme (MYP)

Table: 3 MYP Structure

MYP year (1-5)	AGE	GRADE
Year-1	11-12	**6**
Year-2	12-13	**7**
Year-3	13-14	**8**
Year-4	14-15	**9**
Year-5	15-16	**10**

Choice of Subject Options.
The Learners in the Middle Year Programme (MYP) receive professional guidance from teachers and the careers counsellor in making subject option choices that relate to their career aspirations. The Careers Counsellor manages the process in liaison with other teachers. Final options are approved by the coordinator.

Table 2: MYP Subject Group

	SUBJECT GROUP	
MYP SUBJECT AREAS	Language & Literature	Core Subjects
	Mathematics	
	Individuals and societies	
	Science	
	Language Acquisition	Additional Subjects
	Arts	
	Physical & Health Education	
	Design	
	Interdisciplinary Units	Language and literature, Individuals and societies, sciences, mathematics, and Arts

NOTE: Students in MYP 1, 2, and 3 take all the subjects in the two groups but for students in MYP 4 & 5 take the four core subjects and choose two (2) from the additional subjects group to make a total of six (6) subjects. In MYP 5, each student undertakes a personal project to serve as a significant component of the MYP and is designed to allow students to demonstrate the skills, attitudes, and knowledge they have developed throughout the program.

Study Skills Programme
The school will from time to time select experienced staff who will prepare motivational advice and devices to assist students succeed in their studies.

Personal Target Setting
All learners from Grade 3 to MYP 5 fill in a target setting form at the start of each academic year. MYP students should consult with the MYP coordinator or school counsellor, teachers, and their parents as they set personal targets. The set targets are reviewed each semester during parent-teacher conferences.

Care of School Property

i. Students are expected to give due care to school property provided for their use and education and to respect the property of others.
ii. Students are expected to use school property responsibly and to avoid deliberate, negligent or reckless damage.
iii. Taking or attempting to take another person's property or school property or the damage or destruction of another person's property or school property will result in disciplinary action.
iv. Students who damage or lose school property will be required to reimburse the school for any breakage, destructions, or loss of school property. Parents/legal guardians of students causing damage or loss of any school property will be charged for the repair or replacement cost of the damaged or lost property.
v. Students are expected to use the Library and its facilities responsibly and to avoid deliberate, negligent or malicious use (including mutilation, writing in textbooks, novels, magazine, graffiti etc.). Any student who loses any school book or library book shall be required to replace them.
vi. All destructions and or threat to destroy or damage school property is prohibited. Such acts or threats against school property may lead to disciplinary action. Threat to school property includes but not limited to; breaking, destroying, damaging, defacing, stealing, or setting fire to any property of the school or another person, including buildings, furniture, grounds, roadways, parking lots, signs, fences, equipment, instructional materials, vehicles, or personal belongings.
vii. Concealing information about misuse of school property is prohibited.

General Classroom Rules

The general school rules shall be applicable to all Students while in the classroom. In addition, while in class the following classroom rules shall be observed.
Students should:

a) Show readiness to learn by:

- Being punctual in class
- completing all academic work on time
- possessing all required equipment for class use
- handing in work on time
- handing in the homework diary immediately upon entering the classroom
- attending lessons
- participating in group activity including tidying up or embellishing the classroom environment if required.
- making the most of every learning opportunity

b) Display a dignified level of self-respect through;

- Staying calm and composed at all times.
- Setting high but attainable goals for themselves and doing their best to achieve them.
- Competing fairly and positively.
- Being smart in appearance and showing a positive attitude

C) Display reasonable respect for peers by:

- Being helpful and positive to peers.
- Respecting the views, opinions and interests of others.
- Avoid being disruptive and distractive to others.
- Proper language use.
- Seeking permission to speak or contribute to a lesson by raising a hand.
- Allowing other students to contribute to the discourse during lessons.
- being attentive in class and avoiding talking when a teacher is speaking

d) Show respect for the classroom rules by;

- Maintaining the classroom displays and furniture neat and in good order.
- Not chewing gum in the classroom.
- Respecting the student leader in class.
- Not bringing food or any beverage into classrooms.
- Leaving class only with permission from a teacher.
- Not littering in class.
- Reporting any problem or matter arising in the classroom to the class teacher or any other staff.
- Not eating or drinking in the classroom.

e. Gross Misconduct.

Students shall desist from engaging in and avoid the temptation of being party to or condoning acts of gross misconduct in school and out of school. Such acts include, among others:

i. Fighting**,** intimidating, threatening, distressing, torturing or physically harassing or bullying another student within the school or during out-of-school activities.
ii. Vandalizing school property.
iii. Engagement in any form of impropriety, or criminality which dents the image of the student and/or the school.
iv. Possession and distribution of pornographic materials as well as accessing pornographic internet sites while in school.
v. Forgery, impersonation and falsification of information.
vi. Repeatedly skipping lessons or missing school without a reasonable cause.
vii. Cheating in assignments, tests or exams, assisting others to gain undue favour or credit or plagiarism.
viii. Plagiarism is prohibited in all student work, including imaginative writing, essays, fieldwork reports, presentations, projects, class assignments and holiday work. Plagiarism refers to using and representing the work of others as if it were your own. This entails citing material from other authors, internet sites, or textbooks etc. without mentioning the sources.

f. Acts or Threats of physical violence.

i. The use or threat of physical violence against another person will not be tolerated. Such acts or threats result in school disciplinary action, including the possibility of suspension or expulsion. Acts or threats of physical violence include, assaulting, battering, extortion, fighting, rape, harming, intimidating, or endangering the physical well-being of any student, use or possession of any weapon, and firecrackers.
ii. Abusing, insulting, humiliating, manhandling or threatening a teacher or any member of staff.
iii. Smoking cigarettes or tobacco. Students shall not possess, smoke, or use tobacco products at school, on a school bus, while going to or returning from school, on school field trips, or at any school-related activity on school grounds.
iv. Alcohol: Students shall not possess, distribute, use, or be under the influence of alcohol, alcoholic beverages, or any liquid or solid containing alcohol or alcoholic beverages while under school authority, on a school bus, on school property, or at a school-sponsored activity at any time. The term "alcohol" means any intoxicating beverage or any liquid containing any alcohol regardless of volume.

g. Drugs and other chemical substances

i. Possession, distributing, selling, using, or being under the influence of any drug, any chemical substance that affect the brain or nervous system, or any substance represented to be or believed to be a drug or chemical substance that affects the brain or nervous system, or possession of any drug-related things while under school authority, on school property, or a school-sponsored event is strictly prohibited.
ii. Possession or distribution of counterfeit or ***"look-alike"*** drugs is also strictly prohibited and will be dealt with in the same way as possession or distribution of any other drug.

h) Intimate affective sexual relations in and around the school or during out-of-school activities if

proven beyond a reasonable doubt.

i) Being in possession of firearms, ammunition, machetes and other dangerous weapons.

j) Theft of property belonging to the school or any other person in school.

k) Being arrested charged and found guilty of any criminal offence by the arm of the law.

l) Persistent **Disruption of the School Environment: D**isruption of the environment may result in school disciplinary procedures. Acts of disruption include, among others, rioting or disorderly behaviour that interrupts or disturbs the school operation, inciting others to behave in an unruly manner; defying the authority of school administration or teachers; verbal abuse or cursing of others or the use of vulgar language or conduct; interruption of classes, assemblies, activities, or offices of the school, harassment or bullying; or failure to leave school premises when directed to do.

NOTE: Breach of rules from i) to L) shall lead to immediate suspension from the school

Corrective measures for minor cases may include;

i. Asking students to write apology letters, verbal apologies, verbal warnings, written warnings, restraint, probation, on-report or any other punishment as the administration may decide from time to time.
ii. Reprimand and Counseling: A student may be reprimanded for violating a school rule. Through Counseling, the student may be counselled on the unsuitability of his or her conduct, why his or her conduct is wrong or the motive for the school rule.
iii. Detention: A student who violates any of the school rules may be detained at the school or in class beyond regular school hours and during this time he/she may be required to engage in activities reasonably intended to correct his or her behavior.
iv. De**nial of School Privileges:** A student who violates any of the school rules may be denied normal school privileges for a particular period by the school administration or teacher as an appropriate corrective measure for the misconduct of the student.
v. **Work Assignments:** A student who violates any of the school rules may be assigned non-hazardous and non-humiliating work before or after school or during the school day when not in class.
vi. **Removal from Class: A student who f**or improper disruptive or distractive conduct in any class or activity may be temporarily removed from class by the teacher and assigned to work at school in another place.
vii. Exclusion from co-curricular activities. A student may for a specified period be excluded from participation in some or all co-curricular activities or attendance at school-sponsored events if it is considered that such disciplinary action is appropriate to the misconduct of the student.

Corrective measures for major offences:

i. **Short-Term Suspension from School;** A student who is involved in gross misconduct may be suspended for as many school days as the school administration may consider appropriate to the offence. The student and the parent shall be informed of the reason for possible suspension.
ii. **Inviting parents to school:** The student's parent or legal guardian may be invited to the school to discuss the student's behaviour. Invitation of the parent may be followed by suspension of the student.

Offences that can result in expulsion include:

A student who grossly and repeatedly violates any of the school rules may be expelled from school if all corrective measures have been taken and no positive change of behaviour is shown by the student. In addition, a student may be expelled as a result of being convicted of a criminal offence by a court of law and committing any of the offences in sections **e, f,** and **g** above.

Disciplinary Procedures

Corrective actions will be taken against a student who violates school rules and regulations. The Principal/Head section, members of the administration and the teachers may carry out the corrective disciplinary actions. The Principal/Head section, however, shall maintain the final authority and

responsibility in matters regarding student conduct.

Parents /Legal Guardians Obligations and Expectations

1. **Documents required on the student's file:**

   At admission, parents should submit to the school copies of the following documents;
   - Birth Certificate
   - A clear file/ student registration file
   - 4 passport-size photos
   - Copies of passport or travel documents (foreign students).
   - A transcript of academic record and/or two most recent assessment reports from the previous school.
   - These documents may be verified against original documents or with the source authority.

2. **Fees Payment:**
   i. Parents are encouraged to pay tuition fees monthly or annually to avoid disruption of children's learning. Payment of fees should be done preferably before the start of every month.
   ii. Permission to pay fees in instalments may be given to parents who might be facing financial handicaps, but this follows a formal application to the school finance department.
   iii. Fees once paid are not refundable on account of student withdrawal from school either voluntarily or for disciplinary reasons. Parents who will have paid fees for the next month in advance may apply for a fee refund provided that the month in question has not commenced.

   All school dues are paid in the Bank. No cash payments will be handled in school

3. **Attendance to school events and Parent-Teacher Conferences:**
   The school cherishes parents' involvement in their children's learning. Parents/legal guardians will from time to time be provided with a schedule of events in which their involvement will be needed. Parents are expected to attend the scheduled Parent-Teacher conferences/meetings to discuss the student's progress and any other programmes arranged by the school.

4. **Provision and use of Textbooks:**
   The school provides textbooks for school use. Students are entitled to borrow books from the Library for fart use but such books must be kept and used by the student in the stipulated period and returned to the Library on the due date. Parents are encouraged to monitor their children's use of school books at home.

5 **Uniform.**
   All students will be required to attend school in full school uniform at all times. A student not wearing full school uniform will not be allowed to attend school. Students are required to bring to school the specified games/PHE wear when such activities are timetabled and at such other times may be requested. Failure to do so will render the student liable to disciplinary measures. The uniform kit for sports will be checked by homeroom teachers.

6 **Absence from School:**
   a. The school will monitor students' attendance and is committed to working with parents on this important issue. The school will call parents/legal guardians in order to establish the reasons for a child's absence. In case of planned or impromptu absence, parents/legal guardians should kindly notify the school of their children's absences.
      Absence for a long period including formal leave of absence to travel abroad should be requested only with a genuine explanation by the parents/legal guardians.
   b. Prolonged absence without permission may lead to a student's exclusion from the school list.

7 **Withdrawal of a student:**
   a. Parents who wish to withdraw their children should notify the school in writing at least three weeks in advance to allow the school ample time to prepare leave certificates and other letters of recommendation for a student.
   b. All students intending to withdraw from school will be required to clear with the different departments of the school before the School Leaving Clearance Certificate (SLCC) is issued.

8 Admission Number and Official Name.

i. Upon admission to the school, each student is provided with an Admission Number which will be used in all records concerning the student including the tuition fees bank slip.
ii. Parents will advise the school on the student's official name, which shall be maintained throughout the student's period of attendance at this school. Ordinarily the same shall appear on the child's school and External Examination Certificates.
iii. In case of a legal change of names, the school should be notified in writing with copies of legal affidavits etc. submitted to the school.

9. Parents Contact:

Parents/legal guardians are requested to furnish the school with details of their postal, telephone, email and physical addresses. In case of a change of contact, the school should be advised immediately

10. Medical Care:

a) The school will cater for minor ailments, First Aid and injuries suffered within the school. In case of major attacks that may require referral or expert treatment at the hospital, the cost of treatment will be borne by the parent/legal guardian,
b) In case of an emergency, parents/legal guardians will be contacted immediately. Students will be referred to the hospital or other nearest health facility on the advice of a parent except in situations where contact with the parent is not possible.

11. Student Conduct/Effort:

i. The school expects a very high standard of student academic and social conduct. All students are expected to put in reasonable academic effort.

ii. If, at the discretion of the school, academic progress or student effort does not merit promotion to the next class level, a student may be put on probation.

iii. The school will guide students and advise parents on student's choice of optional subjects or subject groups, which will be based on student ability, interest, career aspiration and availability of space. The school reserves the right to make a final decision on this issue.

iv. The school reserves the right to mete out a punishment, suspend, indefinitely suspend or expel any student in violation of the school, who conducts himself in a way that is considered prejudicial in the wellbeing of other members of the school community or otherwise prejudices the good name of the school. An appeal may be made against any such decision to the school principal/Head section.

v. Parents are encouraged to constantly work with the school to monitor student's academic progress and social conduct.

vi. In case a student has been involved in any activity organized by the school be it Olympiad, science fair, sports, etc. The school will be obliged to use the services of the student in the mentioned activity to enhance his talent. Parents' cooperation is needed.

vii. Parents/legal guardians are encouraged to support and supervise school work done at home. However, the work must be done by the student and not by the parent or guardian. Assisting the student in doing school work at home, will deter teachers from having a reliable understanding of the child's actual level of grasp or mastery of the concepts.

12. Amendment of these Obligations:

The School may modify the Parent/ Legal guardian obligations from time to time if deemed necessary. All amendments and modifications shall apply to all parents /legal guardians.

Computer Use and Ethical Code

Acceptable Computer Use Policy in the Academy

Student Computer and Internet Use Rules

These rules accompany School policy on Computer and Internet Use by Students. Each student is responsible for his actions and activities involving HIA computers, networks and Internet services. These rules provide general guidance concerning the use of HIA computers and examples of prohibited uses. The rules are not intended to describe every possible unacceptable activity by students. Students, parents and school staff who have questions about when and why a particular activity is prohibited are encouraged to contact the Information and Communication Technology administrator.

The use of computers is a privilege for students and becomes a right only if it is a requirement of a given learning package or an examination.

A. Consequences for Violation of Computer Use Policy and Rules

Students' use of HIA computers, networks and Internet services is a privilege, not a right. Compliance with HIA policies and rules concerning computer use is mandatory. Students who violate these policies and rules may have their computer privileges restricted, suspended, revoked or disciplinary action taken.

B. Acceptable Use

HIA computers, networks and Internet services are provided for educational purposes and research consistent with HIA's mission, Vision, Curriculum and instructional goals.

Students are also expected to comply with all instructions from teachers and other school staff or volunteers when using computers.

C. Prohibited Use

In the use of HIA computers and internet, the following are prohibited:

1. Accessing, submitting, posting, publishing, forwarding, downloading, scanning or displaying defamatory, abusive, obscene, vulgar, sexually explicit, threatening, discriminatory, harassing and bullying materials.
2. Using HIA computers, networks and Internet services for any illegal activity or in violation of any School policy or school rules.
3. Downloading or sharing any type of copyrighted materials (including music or films) without the owner's permission.
4. Copying or downloading software without authorization of the ICT teacher.
5. Using HIA computers, networks, and internet services for non-school related purposes such as private financial gain, commercial, or any other personal use not concerned with the educational program or assignments.
6. . Sharing passwords, using other users' passwords, and accessing or using other users' accounts.
7. Any malicious use, disruption or harm to HIA computers, networks and Internet services, including hacking activities and creation or uploading of computer viruses.
8. Unauthorized Access to Blogs or Chat Rooms - Accessing chat rooms, social media such as Facebook, Twitter, My space, WhatsApp, Wayn, Linked-in etc. without

specific authorization from the supervising teacher(s).

9. Using or attempting to use any software or other means to access Internet sites or content blocked by the school filters.

10. Students must not install software on the school computers except with permission

11. Recreational computer use such as playing games, and other non-educational computing is prohibited unless permitted.

D. No Expectation of Privacy

HIA computers remain under the control, custody and supervision of HIA at all times. Students shall not expect privacy in their use of school computers, including e-mail, stored files and internet access logs.

E. Compensation for Losses, Costs and/or Damages

The student and his/her parents will be responsible for any losses, costs or damages incurred by the school for violations of school policies and school rules while the student is using the school computers, including the cost of investigating such violations.

F. Student Security

- A student is not allowed to reveal his full name, address, telephone number, or other personal information on the Internet without prior permission from a teacher.
- Students are not permitted to meet people they have contacted through the Internet without parental permission.
- Students should inform their teacher if they access information or messages that are dangerous, inappropriate or make them uncomfortable in any way.

G. System Security

Any user who attempts to breach system security, causes a breach of system security or fails to report a system security problem shall be subject to disciplinary and/or legal action in addition to having his computer privileges limited, suspended or revoked.

Assessment Policy

Basis for assessment

To ensure that the assessment of all work aligns with IBO and HIA requirements, is clear and has set procedures to promote good practices and deal with malpractice.

Aims

- To ensure the quality of all assessment and reporting for all programmes.
- To support academic honesty and good practice by providing clear guidelines for all staff and students.
- To provide a cohesive guideline for all staff and students in relation to assessment and reporting.
- To provide timely, ongoing and appropriate recording and reporting of student progress that aligns with the assessment philosophy for each programme of study.

Guidelines

- The school communicates its assessment philosophy, policy and procedures to the school community through: the Parent & Student Handbook

Assessment Principle and Practices

Assessment is multi-dimensional and ongoing. It entails both formative and summative assessment in order to consider the whole person. Whilst the main purpose of assessment is to give necessary feedback so that students and all other stakeholders can measure the knowledge, strengths and weaknesses of the student, it is primarily to reveal attainment and progress. A second important aspect of this is to show students a clear pathway to improving attainment and growing progress through motivation.

Assessment goes hand in hand with teaching and learning. The three are inseparably bound and therefore each component is deemed to be interdependent. What is important is that the student, their needs, skills and learning styles are at the centre of everything. The process informs teachers, students and parents of each student's strengths and requirements so that future planning and teaching can be tailored to student needs.

Teachers need to be mindful of the following:

- Assessment of learning – what we have learned.
- Assessment for learning – how we have learned.
- Assessment as learning – what helps us learn.

Our practices

At HIA we monitor the progress of student learning and achievement, ensuring that the following are considered:

- The cultural background of each student and the inherent needs relating to this, such as the acquisition of the English language in a school where English is the language of instruction, are in fact catered for.
- The diverse learning styles of each student need to be catered for in the teaching and learning process through appropriate differentiation.

- The special educational needs of students are daily taken into account - refer to guidelines in the Inclusion Policy.
- Timely and ongoing feedback that is constructive and helpful in order to improve student work and promote positive attitudes to learning.
- Incorporation of both summative and formative assessment in order to progress the students' learning.
- Parents are sent monthly progressive reports and they (parents) can also inquire directly from teachers and logical feedback is obtained. The school is also developing a system where parents can view student progress and attendance on demand.
- Regular evaluation of all programmes of learning in order to remain current with IBO and HIA curricula as well as with ever-changing teaching practices to implement them.
  Peer assessment, working and assessing in groups, as well as self-assessment are equally as valid and important to the learning process. In general, assessment should be a positive tool used as part of the learning process that not only gives students feedback but also informs the teacher in relation to their practice and possible ways to improve

Internal and External Assessment

At HIA we consider both internal and external assessment. Assessment is a continuous process throughout education. The process informs teachers, students and parents of each student's strengths and requirements so that future planning and teaching can be tailored to student needs. The school uses a range of strategies and tools to assess students' learning both formative and summative. Both are essential and linked. Teachers must have an understanding of summative assessment expectations in their subject in order to aid progress in formative assessment.

Formative assessment (diagnostic) – the teacher gathers, analyses, interprets and uses evidence to improve student learning, and through this, works with individual students to help them improve.

- A range of different techniques must be used. Diagnostic assessment provides information for teachers on what or how students are achieving at a particular time.
- Diagnostic tools give detailed information about students' learning need and prompt reflection on appropriate teaching strategies to meet these.
- Diagnostic assessment should inform future programme planning, and give valuable information to teachers on how they may differentiate to scaffold the learning to meet the individual needs of students.

  Formative assessment refers to all those assessment activities undertaken by teachers, and by the students themselves, which provide information, to be used as feedback to modify the teaching and learning activities in which they are engaged. Such assessments become formative when the evidence is actually used to adapt the teaching to meet the needs of students.' (Black & William, 1998.)
- Internal assessment should be formative and comprise a range of formal and informal assessment procedures used by teachers during the learning process in order to modify teaching and learning activities to improve student attainment

Summative assessment - the teacher will measure student performance based on the assessment criteria.

- Summative assessment summarizes the development of learners at a particular time, E.g. after a unit of work. The learner sits on a test and the teacher assigns a mark/grade. The test aims to summarize learning up to that point.
- Summative assessment measures the outcome of an educational programme for the students who participated in that programme; that is, what skills and knowledge, relevant to the programme, they have at the conclusion of the programme.
- Although it is desirable to use the results to inform further learning, for example, results from end-of-year assessments are used to inform programmes for the following year, it is typically the results of the assessments themselves that are the primary focus of attention.

Appendix 1: School Policies

The school Language Policy can be accessed here

The school Academic Integrity Policy can be accessed here

The School Admission and Inclusion Policy can be accessed here

Appendix 2: Agreement

I/We .....

Parent(s)of.....GRADE……hereby, accept all conditions written above future of our son and of his well-being in Hilal International Academy.

Date.....

Signatures:

.....	.....	.....
PARENT	**STUDENT**	**PRINCIPAL/ HEAD SECTION**